



AT A WEEK LONG FESTIVAL celebrating the end of the dry season among the Wodaabe of Nigeria and Niger, makeup and jewelry are used to great effect in the quest for a marriage partner. Unusually though, it is the men doing the primping and preening. They spend hours applying makeup for the *yaake*, a contest in which they charm the female judges by making silly faces. In another contest, called the *geerewol*, men parade and dance in their finest clothes and jewelry for hours. If a man impresses one of the judges she may consent to marry him.

